Once Upon A Time...

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59273791.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adam & Teela

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam, Teela (He-Man), Randor (He-Man), Marlena (He-Man), Huntara (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Princess Adora (She-Ra), Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer is a good friend, Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Huntara is a princess, Adam and Teela are married, Bow and Glimmer are together, Curses, First Kisses, Huntara is evil, Shadow Weaver is always evil, Sort of based on fairy tales, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), like romantically, Jealous Catra (She-Ra), Sad Adora (She-Ra), fluff no smut

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by masternoveller

Summary

This does not start with 'Once Upon A Time.'
Just saying.
But it does have a curse, princesses, princes, kings, queens, knights and a witch called Shadow Weaver here to ruin everything!

Or

Princess Adora agrees to marry Princess Huntara.
Even though she doesn't really want to and is only doing out of duty.
Will it work out or will there be a lot of spanners thrown in the works?

Notes

I've been watching that series Once Upon A Time, and this popped up in my head.
So, yeah, enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

“I don’t have a good feeling about this, princess.” Catra warns as she tries to grab Adora’s arm to pull her back, “Come on. We can go raid the kitchen again.”
“Where’s your sense of adventure, knight Catra?” Adora teases with a smirk when she stops to look at the magicat, “Besides, what’s the worst that can happen since I’ve got my trusty knight with me?
Catra rolls her eyes, “I’m not a knight yet, dumbass.”
“You will be soon.” Adora grins knowingly, “You literally already are one.”
The blonde nudges her playfully as Catra scoffs out lightly, “That’s if your parents think I’m good enough.”
“You are. Good enough.” Adora turns and hugs the magicat, “You have always been good enough. And they’ll see that. Just like I do.”
Catra nods as she leans into Adora’s embrace, “Okay, enough mushy stuff. Come on, let’s get back.”
Adora laughs, releasing Catra and then turns back to the opening in the tree line where she was headed in the first place, “I still really want to go in there, though.”
“I know you do.” Catra nods, “But, we can come back when it’s daylight. It’s already getting late and I’ve got word that you’ve got a suiter coming to court you at dinner tomorrow.”
“I hate these set ups.” Adora groans, dramatically falling into the magicat’s arms, “Why can’t you just marry me? All you have to do is ask.”
“That’s not how this works, princess.” Catra sighs, “You’re royalty. You have to marry other royalty.”
“I’m not even going to rule. Not when Adam is next in line.” Adora reasons, “And besides, I should be allowed to marry whoever I want.”
“You should. I’m not disputing that.” Catra says as her ears perk up when her phone pings, “That’s probably them asking where you are.”
“This sucks.” Adora pouts, “I don’t want to marry because I have to.”
“Yeah, I know.” Catra agrees before slipping her hand in Adora’s,

“Come on, I have to get you back, lest I lose my job.”
“Fine.” Adora grumbles but accepts the furry hand in reaching out to her.

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“So… you like her, huh?” Catra asks as Adora and her share a quiet moment together, “Have you, like… kissed her? Or did she kiss you?”
“No.” Adora answers with a blush, “No kissing.”
“Do you want to?” Catra probes a little more, trying to mask her interest.
“I don’t know.” Adora replies biting her bottom lip as she glimpses over at the magicat, “Why?”
Catra shrugs nonchalantly, “No reason.”
“Catra.” Adora reaches out for the magicat, only for Catra to flinch, “What...?”
“I have to get back.” Catra turns away from Adora’s touch, “Duty calls.”
“Catra.” Adora tries again.
“It’s fine, Adora.” Catra stops at the door, “I’m not even a knight. But I’ll still be here to protect and serve you.”
“Cat…” Adora tries one more time unsuccessfully as the magicat closes the door before the blonde can even finish her name, Adora stares at the door, a tear rolls down her cheek as she quickly schools herself when there’s a knock on the door. She quickly opens to door, expecting the magicat to be there, but it’s not, “Oh, hi mom.”
“Oh, Adora.” The queen pulls her daughter into her arms, “What’s wrong?”
“Nothing.” Adora sniffles into her mother’s shoulder.
“It’s Catra, isn’t it?” Adora nods, “Don’t worry about her. She’ll be fine. And she’ll accept your future marriage to Princess Huntara when the time comes.”
“Marriage?” Adora pulls back, “We’ve only just met!”
“And I saw the way you looked at her.” The queen smirks, “You like her. And it will be a good union of the two kingdoms.”

Adora just stares back in shock, before she nods, “I guess I could get to know her better.”
“Fantastic.” The queen beams, clapping her hands together, “Your father will be so happy to hear of this.”
Adora nods again, trying to put on a smile as her mother looks at her again.
“Are you not happy?” The queen asks.
“It’s not that.” Adora sighs.
“Adora. We’ve been through this.” The queen holds the blonde by the shoulders, “Catra is a fine… warrior for now. But you need to marry for the good of the kingdom.”
“I know, I know. Adora shakes her head, “It’s just…”
“No. Stop thinking about that magicat and come along.” The queen grabs Adora’s wrist, “I believe Huntara is waiting for you in the gardens.”

***

“What am I supposed to do?” Catra grumbles back into the tracker pad, “She’s going to marry that brute of a princess and there’s nothing I can do about it.”
“Sounds like loser talk to me.” The voice on the other end snarks back and Catra growls at them, “There’s always something you can do.”
“If you haven’t noticed, Sparkles. Unlike you, I’m not royalty.” Catra grunts back, pacing backwards and forwards in her room, “And… and look at me!”
“I’m looking.” Glimmer replies with an eye roll.
“I’m nothing. I’m not even a knight!” Catra growls out again, “I have nothing to offer her. At all.”
“That’s so not true, Catra.” Glimmer says with a huff, “And you know it.”
“I don’t know it.” Catra throws back, “Whatever. As long as this… Huntara doesn’t hurt her.”
“You’re just going to give up?” Glimmer shrieks.
“Well, what else am I supposed to do?” Catra sits back down on the edge of her bed, “I’m… I’m no one.”

“Fight, you dumbass!” Glimmer shouts out from all the way in another kingdom, “What happened to the Catra I knew? The one that swore that she would marry Adora, no matter what?”
“Things are… different.” Catra sighs, “I can’t compete.”
“Well, you still have time.” Glimmer says, “We’ll come up with something.”
There’s a knock on Catra’s room door, the magicat looks back at the tracker pad, “I have to go, Sparkles. Good talk.”
“Call me back, ass!” Glimmer shouts out before Catra ends the call and gets up to open the door.
The magicat opens her door and to her surprise, Adora rushes in and past her, going straight to Catra’s bed and sits down. The magicat looks around outside before shutting her door, leaning up it and then looks over at Adora, “To what do I owe the princess’ presence?”
Adora takes a few breaths in and out and then looks down at her hand, a new ring on her finger as Catra waits for the inevitable.
Evenutally Adora speaks, “I’m getting married.”
“I know.” Catra breathes out as she tries not to grit her teeth while suppressing a growl, she looks at the new piece of jewellery adorning Adora’s finger, “Nice ring.”
“Is it?” Adora scoffs.
“When?”
“What?” Adora turns her head suddenly at the question.
“When are you getting married?” Catra asks again.
“In 3 months time.” Adora answers frowning.
“Why don’t you look happy about this?” Catra sits down next to Adora, “I thought you liked that mountain of muscle.”
Adora leans back, lying down on Catra’s bed, “That means everything is going to change.”
“Everything changes. That’s how life it.” Catra leans back with her, taking Adora’s ringed hand and inspecting it, “This is a bit flash, isn’t it?”
Adora looks at it and then at Catra, and they break out in laughter, “She’s… something.”
“Yeah.” Catra nods, lacing her fingers around Adora’s, “Are you happy?”
Tears well up in Adora’s eyes, “Don’t ask me that… how can I

marry someone I don't love?! I can't even, haven't… even kissed her! And I don't want to!"
Catra nods and then pulls the blonde into her, "Okay." The magicat starts up her purr, knowing it'll make the blonde feel a little bit better, "What can I do?"
Adora shakes her head, sobbing into Catra's neck as they lay together for the night.

When Catra wakes up, Adora is gone.
She gets up and goes over her morning rituals before getting ready for the tournament she's been preparing for since hearing of becoming a knight, putting her armour on and grabbing her weapons before stepping out and into main arena of the castle. She gets into line, along with all the other participants for the tournament. The top two contenders earning knighthoods as she gets ready for the first round of proceedings. She looks up and sees Adora sitting a row below the king and queen and alarmingly, she's sitting next to the princess of the Crimson Waste. Adam and his wife, Teela sit on the other side of them as well.
Upon seeing Catra, Adora waves to her. The magicat smiles under her helmet, waving back and then upon seeing the scowls on the king and queen's faces as Catra puts her arm down and gets back to the tournament.
The magicat gets through the first few rounds easily enough, the crowd seem to be on her side as she puts down another opponent. The final round has 5 contenders, all vying for the same thing. The magicat eyes the other opponents wearily, knowing this won't be easy. She's easily the smallest and leanest one out there, compared to the others that are huge and bulging with muscles, perfect to guard the Eternian kingdom. After all, who would be afraid of a magicat?
By the end of the tournament, Catra and one more stand as the final two left.
They face each other, panting and still catching their breaths as the King stands up, signalling for silence as he starts to speak.
"The final two stand before you!" He announces, "The last round is a duel between our final competitors! Only one of which will

earn Knighthood today."
"What?!" Adora stands up abruptly, "That's not fair! You can't just change the rules!"
"Sit down, Princess Adora." Her father tells her. Adora glares back at him, knowing exactly why he changed the rules and reluctantly sits back down, "Good. Now." He turns back to the arena as the crowd murmurs in confusion, "Get your weapons! And then get to your marks!"
Both competitors look at each other, before rushing over to grab a weapon and a shield and then heading to their markers.
Catra looks through the slits in her helmet as she readies her sword and shield, staring down her much larger and more experience opponent.
The king grins as he once again signals for the crowd to be silent, "The people of Eternia! Take a look at your final 2!" The crowd cheers as Adora bites her bottom lip in anticipation as her father continues on, "As I said before, only 1 will earn knighthood today!"
Huntara nudges Adora, "This is the best Eternia can offer? Ha." Adora ignores her betrothed, looking down at the other fighter as Catra stays at the ready.
"Begin!" The king announces and the 2 competitors left, square off.

The fight lasts a lot longer than expected.
Despite Catra's lithe stature, she is quick and agile.
The other fighter is bigger, stronger and has a good defence.
It seems that they are quite evenly matched despite their differences and soon both have pushed each other back and are staring at each other, breathing heavily and trying to catch their breathes. Catra had discarded her shield in the first few minutes of the fight, while the other fighter used it as a weapon, throwing it at the magicat and managing to strike Catra with it, the gash on the magicat's head was still dripping with blood as she had no time to take care of it, the only thing she could do to fix it was to discard the helmet that obscured her vision by clogging up the blood.

Huntara looked on boredly as Adora fisted her hands, encouraging her magicat under her breath.
"Is it supposed to take this long?" The Crimson Waste princess bemoans before an idea comes into her head, she turns to Adora's father, "Care for me to join? I'll prove that neither of them is worthy of your knighthood and prove that I am more than capable to protect your daughter."
The king thinks about it for a moment as Adora stands up, "No. You can't do this."
"Hm... wait a minute, Adora." The king raises his finger at her, "I like the way Huntara thinks…"
Huntara preens a little as Adora just glares at her, the larger woman nudges Adora again, "Come on, don't you want to see your future wife show you how it's really done?"
Adora continues to frown, turning away from Huntara and then to her father, "Father, you can't do this. It's not fair."
"No. I think it's very fair." The king replies before nodding to Huntara, "If you're up for it."
Huntara stands up and shrugs off her formal jacket, "I'm so bored. I look forward to stretching out my muscles."
"Very well." The king raises his arms and a horn is blown, both fighters in the arena look up in confusion, "There's been a change of plans! My daughter's future wife will take on our final 2 to decide whether or not they are worthy of knighthood!"
The crowd murmurs amongst themselves again as Huntara waves around to the crowd to gesture that she's the future wife to Adora.
The king moves to speak to Huntara so that only she can hear him, "If you lose, you will no longer be worthy to wed my daughter. Understand?"
The seriousness in the king's voice as Huntara nods back, "Don't worry, I'll prove that your wannabe knights are nothing but… wannabes."
Huntara laughs as she makes her way to the arena floor, foregoing the need for any weapons, instead, standing in the middle of the arena with a smirk on her face.
"Begin!" The king shouts out and the trio begin to fight, Adora's father nudges his daughter, "We'll see if she's good enough for

you.”
Adora rolls her eyes and goes back to watching the action in the middle of the arena.

Huntara picks up the other fighter, lifting him up into the air and throwing him into the wall, indenting him into it as he eventually flops down to the ground, unmoving. Catra runs over to him, sure, he was her opponent, but he’s also been a friend on the training ground, she crouches down and inspects him, turning him onto his back as blood drips from his mouth, looking up at the magicat he says, “Congratulations, Catra. You did it…”
“Hey! Hey!” Catra shakes him a little as he closes his eyes, “No! Stay awake Sawyer!” She turns to look around the arena and screams out, “Medic! Medic!”
A few medics sprint out and to his aid, patting the resident magicat on the arm to signal that they’ve got him, one of the medics says to Catra, “We got him. Now, go get your girl.”
Catra looks at the medic and nods.

Catra picks up her sword and holds it up, a snarl on her lips as she faces down Huntara.
The large purple woman crosses her arms over her chest intimidatingly, a smirk on her face as she narrows her eyes at Catra, “Well? What are you waiting for? Strike me down.”
Catra growls back, dropping the sword and then sprinting full speed at the hulk of a woman, her claws extending as she goes to slash at Huntara, but with the full day of fighting, she’s tired and slower than what she normally would be as Huntara easily dodges the attack and pushes the magicat down.
“Awe, kitty’s got claws, huh?” Huntara taunts as Catra bares her teeth, “Sorry, I don’t have a ball of twine for you to play with. Though, once I put you down, I’ll have something even better to play with.”
Catra glares at the large woman as she steadies her breathing and growls once more.
Huntara looks up at Adora and waves, the blonde doesn’t respond as the large woman steps forward towards Catra, lauding over

her, “You’ve got it bad for her, don’t you?”
Catra looks up at Adora and she can see the blonde smile back at her, the magicat can’t help but smile back.
“Pathetic.” Huntara taunts again, “Don’t worry, kitty cat. I’m going to take *real* good care of blondie up there. Every. Night.”
That taunt has Catra seeing red as she launches herself foolishly at the large woman, only to be knocked down hard to the ground. Before the magicat can get back to her feet, Huntara picks her up and throws her back down again. A cloud of dust rises from where Catra’s body impacts the sand before she feels Huntara’s foot on her chest, pushing down.
Catra tries to shove Huntara’s foot off her but to no avail.
“Stop it!” Adora shouts out from the stands, Adam and Teela holding the blonde back from rushing down into the arena as well, “Leave her alone!”
Catra groans in pain, her muscles scream out in pain from a full day of fighting and her head hurts from the impact of the two drops to the ground, glaring up at Huntara, “Fuck. You.’
“That’s no way to talk to your future leader.” Huntara smirk widens, “I’ve just proven that this kingdom’s future best fighters are worthless. And once I marry Adora, I will take over this kingdom and all its weak people.”
And to prove her point, she digs her foot down deeper into Catra’s chest.
“Your champion!” The king announces, “Huntara! The future wife of my daughter!”
The crowd claps but there’s no cheers as Huntara raises her arms up in victory at the lacklustre applause, she turns back to royal box with a grin, she looks back down at Catra, “And that, is how you do it.”

“Catra! Catra! Slow down!” Adora chases after the magicat who’s storming off with a limp after the tournament, “Please, stop!”
“Why Adora?’ Catra abruptly turns to face the princess, “What?! What do you want from me?!”
“Stop!” Adora steps towards her friend, “Please.”
Catra’s anger subsides upon seeing the look on Adora’s face,

“I’m… I’m sorry. I’m not good enough. That was proven today. I’ll never be good enough.”
“What do you have to be good enough for?!” Adora takes a good look over the magicat.
“I have to go.” Catra turns back around, “Sparkles said she could use another soldier at Bright Moon.”
“What? You’re just going to leave?!” Adora says angrily, “What about me?”
“What about you, princess?” Catra spits back before dropping her anger once more, “Go be with that… she-hulk. You are marrying her after all.” The magicat looks at the ring on Adora’s finger, “Good luck. Go, be happy. I… I’ll miss you.”
Before Adora can say anything in reply, the magicat drops to fours and begins to sprint away. Adora knows there’s no way she’ll be able to catch up to Catra, not in the garbs she’s still wearing from the tournament. All she can do is watch until her best friend is gone and out of sight, there’s nothing she can do but let the tears stream down her face.

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“You’re such an idiot.” Glimmer chastises the magicat who’s lounging around in the princess’ couch, “Why did you just leave?”
“I’m not going to watch her be with… Huntara.” Catra says the name with such disdain, “She proved that I’m not good enough. Not good enough to be a knight and not good enough to be with Adora.”
“Idiot.” Glimmer mumbles again, “I’m going to get Bow up here to try and talk some sense into you.” She walks to her balcony and shouts out, “Bow! Bow! Where are you?!”
“Hey Glimmer!” Bow waves from the bushes, “What’s up?”
“Come up here!” Glimmer shouts out to him.
“You know I can’t get in there after hours.” Bow rolls his eyes and then he yelps when Glimmer magically appears in front of him before disappearing into a cloud of sparkles and then back into Glimmer’s room, he looks around and spots Catra, “Oh, hey Catra.”

“Hey.” Catra lies on her back on the couch with her eyes closed.
“Glimmer! You’re going to get me *and* you in trouble. Again!” Bow scolds Glimmer, “Remember the last time your mom caught me in here when you were supposed to be grounded?”
“Well, I’m not grounded this time. So it should be fine.” Glimmer brushes off Bow’s concern, “We need to help Catra get out of this rut.”
“Oh.” Bow looks at Catra again, “What can I do?”

***

It’s been three days since Catra left.
Adora runs back to her room, her world just got a lot smaller now that Catra’s really left as she tries to calm herself down from the marriage that looms over her. She feels helpless with the whole situation. The only saving grace is that Huntara has to return to the Crimson Waste to deal with a few issues in her kingdom.
After dinner with her parents and another heated discussion as to how unfair it was to only select one this year for knighthood and then on top of that, add Huntara into the mix, Adora stormed out and now sits back in her room.
She grabs her tracker pad and dials up Glimmer who answers on the third ring, “Glimmer!”
“Oh, hi Adora!” Glimmer waves into the tracker pad.
“Is Catra with you?” Adora asks quickly, trying to look around in the background for her friend, “Is she okay?”
“She’s the same as when you asked the last time you called.” Glimmer rolls her eyes, “But, she’s not here right now. She’s gone off on a training exercise with the Bright Moon guards.”
“Oh.” Adora’s face sinks, “Okay. Can you ask her to call me?”
“Sure.” Glimmer smiles back a little sadly, “Adora? Are you okay?”
“No.” Adora shakes her head as her bottom lip starts to quiver, “I don’t want to marry Huntara!”
“Then don’t.” Adora just frowns back at her friend, “You don’t have to do anything you don’t want to do.”
“But I have to!” Adora groans, “It’s for the good of the kingdom.”
“Not at the cost of your happiness.” Glimmer sighs out, “You

deserve to be happy too."
Adora nods but Glimmer can see that she doesn't believe it, "What can I do?"
"I wish I could help." Glimmer provides, "Unfortunately your people's customs are a lot more different from the ones here at Bright Moon."
"I know." Adora nods again, "I just… I just miss her."
"I'm so sorry, Adora." Glimmer consoles.
"I think… I think I'm going to go for a walk. Clear my mind and get some fresh air." Adora says, "Talk later?"
"Of course! Maybe Bow will be around later!" Glimmer replies cheerfully.
"Maybe Catra too?" Adora asks hopefully.
Glimmer's smile drops a little, "Sorry, Adora. The training she's on is for a few days. So, she should be back by the end of the week at the earliest…"
"Oh."
"Yeah, but call us back when you're free! Bow misses you too!" Glimmer smiles again, "Enjoy your walk!"
"Okay. Talk soon." Adora replies, "Bye, Glim."
Glimmer waves into the camera, "Bye, Adora!"

Adora walks into the woods and towards the spot where her and Catra last ventured together, the opening of the tree line brings her a sense of peace with the familiarity and then a little sadness. She stands on the edge of the tree line and looks inside.
She remembers Catra telling her that they should come back during the day instead at night, and once again, Adora finds herself there at night. Staring into the darkness even the moonlight can't light up. She takes a deep breath and steps forward.
In the back of her mind, she can hear Catra's words, and it makes her smile a little as she takes another step forward. And then soon enough, she's gone so deep that all she sees is darkness.

"Hello, Adora. I've been waiting for you." a dark an eerie voice says.

Adora gasps, stepping back and tripping over something and falling onto her butt, she winces as she looks around in the darkness, "Who… who said that!?"

"All alone. No one to talk to. No one who cares about you." The voice drawls and it feels like there's a dark presence surrounding Adora.

"Who are you?! Show yourself!" Adora shouts, spinning around in the darkness before gasping when she sees two bright white orbs of light, "Come out!" Adora shouts again, her voice shaking and shattering any type of confidence that she tries to convey.
The figure steps forward to reveal themselves, "My apologies, Princess Adora."
"How do you know my name?" Adora asks taking a step back as the other figure takes a step forward, "Who are you? Speak!"
"No need to shout, child." The figure replies, "I can hear you just fine."
"I will not ask you again. Who are you and how do you know my name?" Adora grits her teeth, stopping them from chattering.
"My name is Shadow Weaver and everyone in this kingdom knows who you are, child." Shadow Weaver replies, her white eyes moving and contorting to her expressions, "Now, what brings you to my domain?"
"I… I didn't mean to enter your domain." Adora starts to apologise, "I'll just be on my way then."
"No." Adora freezes suddenly, unable to move as the woman's voice chuckles, "Stay. I haven't had company in such a long time."
"Oh." Adora tries not to panic, "But I really need to go. My family is waiting for me."
"Tell me, Adora." Shadow Weaver drags out the blonde's name, "Why would a princess like you venture so far away from the castle, alone and willingly?"
"This is all a mistake." Adora tries to get free from the invisible force holding her in place, "I didn't mean to trespass."
Shadow Weaver tsks, "Do not lie to me, child."
"I'm not." Adora tries again.
This time Shadow Weaver sighs, "You are." The figure moves in front of Adora, lifting her chin up to her gaze, "From my

experience, only those who are running away tend to find themselves here. Is that what you are doing? Running away?"
Adora grits her teeth, "No. I'm not running away."
The white eyes narrow on Adora's, and for a moment it feels like Shadow Weaver is plotting something, before the figure finally speaks, "Where is that… furred friend of yours? The one you were here with on the edge last time?"
Adora's eyes widen, "You… you saw us?"
"Of course." Shadow Weaver replies amused, "How could I not? The two of you were so… loud."
"Oh, I'm sorry about that." Adora says as she feels the hold on her releasing just a little bit, "If you just let me… I can just go and leave you in peace."
"You haven't answered my question, Adora. Where is… Catra?" Shadow Weaver's voice tinges on amusement as she hears Adora swallow hard, "Has she abandoned you? And here I thought she was supposed to be your best friend."
"She is my best friend!" Adora throws back angrily, the accusation of anything else makes her blood boil before she slumps her shoulders down a little, "She's helping my friend, Glimmer in Bright Moon and should be back soon."
"No. She won't." Shadow Weaver chuckles, "She's not coming back because she's weak. Love is weak."
"Love?"
"Ah… you don't even know?" Shadow Weaver laughs mockingly, "No wonder she ran off."
"She didn't." Adora says barely above a whisper, "She wouldn't…"
"She did." Shadow Weaver says definitively, "What would you do to get her back?"
Adora glares back, "There's… there's nothing I can do. I'm getting married. And that's that."
"Well, then, congratulations are in order." Shadow Weaver taunts, "But… why do you not look… happy?"
Adora looks away, it's obvious she's not happy as she contemplates answering at all, instead she decides to huff back a response.
Shadow Weaver smiles in the darkness, her eyes narrowing at the gestures, "Ah… you don't love this… fiancé of yours." Adora's head

whips back, confirming Shadow Weaver's statement, "I assume you are only marrying out of this a sense of duty."
Adora looks down.
"Pity."
"It doesn't matter." Adora sighs, "Let me go back."
"What if I offered you… something else?" Shadow Weaver sweetly suggests, "Something that would free you of this… obligation?"
"Like what?"
"Freedom, I guess, from duty." Shadow Weaver adds, "Unless you want to marry this… person who doesn't make you happy."
"That's not…" Adora starts before slumping down again, "What do I have to do?"
"It's quite simple, really." Shadow Weaver moves into the light and Adora sees the slender woman for the first time in clarity, her dark red robes like blood, her face covered with the shiny mask that reflects what little light is in the space, as she holds out something in her hand, "Here. Take this."
"What is it?" Adora looks down at the red apple.
"It's an apple, Adora." Shadow Weaver says with a slight shake of her head, "Surely, your education should be better to know your different fruits."
Adora huffs indignantly, "I know what an apple is." The blonde crosses her arms over her chest, "Why are you giving me this?"
"This apple will solve all your problems." Adora stares back at Shadow Weaver in disbelief, "You don't believe me?"
"No. How will an apple solve my problems? Am I supposed to throw this at Huntara and she'll magically not want to marry me?" Adora starts to blurt out, "Or throw it at my parents so that they won't force me into marrying someone I don't love?!"
Upon blurting that out, Adora quickly covers her mouth with her hands and Shadow Weaver begins to laugh, "No, child. This is not for you to throw."
"Then what?"
"You eat it." Shadow Weaver answers incredulously, before adding, "Are you sure your education is up to scratch?"
"I know what fruit is!" Adora stomps her foot down in irritation, "Why should I eat it?"
"Think of me… as your fairy godmother." Shadow Weaver muses,

“Or just a good Samaritan that wants to help.”
“Why would you want to help me?” Adora narrows her eyes at Shadow Weaver, “What’s in it for you?”
“It’s quite simple really.” The tall woman starts to pace around, “The apple is just something… think of it as a show of faith.”
“I… no, thank you.” Adora replies back, “I would like to leave now.”
“No. You came in willingly. What makes you think you’ll leave willingly?” Shadow Weaver threatens as she disappears back into the darkness and then the sound of an evil laughter echoes around Adora.

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“I haven’t heard from Adora in a few days.” Glimmer says concerned, “She usually calls every day. Where is she?”
Catra shrugs as she flops onto Glimmer’s bed, “I don’t know. It’s not like her.”
“I just said that!” Glimmer groans, before glaring at the magicat, “I know! I’ll call her Adam! Also, get your dirty ass off my bed!”
“Go for it.” Catra replies with a laugh and gets off Glimmer’s bed and moves to the couch.
Glimmer dials up Adam’s number, he picks up after a few rings, “Adam! Hi!”
“Uh, Glimmer? Why are you calling me?” Adam asks in confusion, “Adora’s not here.”
“That’s exactly why I’m calling!” Glimmer shouts into the device, “I haven’t been able to get in contact with her in a few days and was wondering if you know where she is?”
“Uh… I haven’t seen her dinner a few days ago, I think.” He answers and then spots Catra in the background, “Maybe Catra knows! They’re usually thick as thieves.”
Glimmer groans, “She doesn’t know!”
“Why not?” He tries to look into the background for the magicat, “Catra and my sister are like inseparable!”
“Well, obviously we aren’t.” Catra says loudly.
“Oh… why not?” Adam repeats, genuinely baffled, “I thought you

and my sister were totally in love."
Catra groans out loudly as Glimmer cuts in, "It might have something to do with Adora *marrying* Huntara in a few months time…"
"Oh…" Adora says again, "That makes sense."
"Yeah." Glimmer breathes out.
"But she doesn't love Huntara." Adam says, "I've seen the way they look at each other and there's no way she's in love with her. Not with the way she looks at Catra."
"Adam! Focus!" Glimmer grunts out, "Have. You. Seen. Adora? Or know where she could be?"
Adam scratches his head, thinking hard for a moment, "She was at dinner the other night..."
"Okay…" Glimmer waves her hand around for him to continue.
"I guess she must have sneaked out after." Adam recalls, "Sorry, me and Teela have been learning the ropes. Lots of meetings if you know what I mean."
"Yes. I know." Glimmer nods.
"Mother and father want to retire at some point instead of straight up dying." Adam says, "And they want me and Teela up to scratch to take over when they've had enough, I guess."
"Can they do that?" Catra asks as she comes back behind Glimmer and looks into the screen as Adam nods, "Hm. That's… interesting."
"Ugh. It's just *so* much to learn!" Adam groans out.
"Do you know where Adora would have gone?" Glimmer steers the conversation back on track again, "Like, where does she usually go?"
"I have no idea." Adam replies and then looks at Catra, "Catra would have a better idea."
"Right…" Glimmer sighs, "Well, thanks, I guess."
"Wait, hold on!" Adam calls out, "I forgot to mention we had a new… advisor, arrive not that long ago."
"Advisor?" Catra asks, her face squished next to Glimmer's, "What advisor? Why do you need another advisor?!"
"I don't, frankly." Adam rolls his eyes, "But mother and father are insisting on her being part of our… team."
"Who is this… advisor?" Catra asks as Bow comes in.

“Adam!” Bow shouts out as he comes over and squishes his face on the other side of Glimmer’s, “It’s so good to see you!”
“Bow! It’s so good to see you, too!” Adam gushes back, “How’s the archery going?”
“Ahem!” Glimmer interrupts the bromance, “Can we please get back on track?!”
“Oh, right.” Adam chuckles as he waves to Bow, who waves right back, “The advisor’s name is Shadow Weaver. Weird name, right?”
“Shadow Weaver?” Catra repeats, “Are you sure?”
“Yes. Very sure.” Adam nods, “Why?”
“Crap! That’s not good.” Catra starts to pace, “I’ve heard about her when I was trekking here from the castle. And from what I heard… she’s not good.”
“She is quite eerie.” Adam adds unhelpfully, “And she’s very patronising. Especially to me and Teela! I don’t know why mother and father have kept her.”
“Dark magic.” Catra frowns as she turns to Glimmer and Bow, “I have to go.”
“Woah!” Glimmer grabs Catra’s arm, “Where do you think you’re going?”
“Back to the kingdom! Adora’s in trouble!” Catra growls out, shaking Glimmer off her, “If you’re going to come with me, make it quick. I’m leaving here in an hour, with or without you guys.”
“We’re coming!” Bow shoots up.
Catra goes back to the device, “Adam, keep an eye on Shadow Weaver. Don’t let her out of your sight.”
“How am I supposed to do that?” He grumbles.
“Otherwise, interrogate her. Find out where she’s hiding Adora!” Catra growls out, “I don’t care what you do, but do not alert her that we are onto her!”
“She doesn’t even know you guys!” Adam laughs, but nods, “But, fine. Teela and I will make her talk.”
“We’ll try to get there as soon as we can!” Glimmer says as a farewell and then hangs up, turning to the room to find Catra already gone and Bow starting to pack, “Okay, I’ve got one hour to recharge.”

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“Keep up if you’re going to come with me!” Catra growls out at her two companions, “We have to hurry!”
“Just… let… me… teleport… us!” Glimmer grumbles right back.
“Glim…” Bow pants out, “You’ll drain all your magic if you do.” He then turns to Catra, “Go ahead! We’ll be right behind you!”
Catra looks back, shaking her head a little before nodding back at him, “Don’t take too long.” She says and then adds, “Don’t do anything stupid.”
“You’re taking all the stupid with you!” Glimmer throws back with a small smile on her lips.
Catra rolls her eyes, “Whatever.”
“We’re right behind you!” Bow repeats before coming to a stop next to Glimmer, puffing out, “We’re way behind you…”
Glimmer watches as the magicat disappears into the trees, huffing out a, “Show off.”

Catra gets back to the castle in good time, she pushes her way through until she bumps into Adam, “Adam! What the…?” and then falls to the ground, “Oof…”
Adam quickly pulls the magicat back up to her feet, “Catra! You’re back!”
“Yeah, did you find Adora?” Adam shakes his head.
“No, nothing yet.” Catra droops a little, “Don’t worry, we’ll find her.”
Catra looks around, “Where is Shadow Weaver?”
“She’s with my parents.” Adam replies sheepishly, “I don’t know what they see in her.”
“I don’t either… from what I’ve heard from the people I’ve passed going to and from Bright Moon, they’ve got nothing good to say about her.” Catra regales, “She must have something on them or she’s got them under a spell. Has she done anything?”
“Yeah.” He looks down at his feet, “She’s… she’s been trying to take over the kingdom.”
“What?!”
“Teela and I have been fighting this and so far we still have the peoples favour. But…” He rubs the back of his neck, “I don’t know how long it’s going to last.”

“What do you mean?”
“She’s been promising all these things...” Adam pulls Catra away and into another room for privacy, “She’s lying to everyone. Saying that because of her, the crops are growing better and she’s practically promising the world. Which, come on! There’s no way!”
“I know. Have you managed to ask her about Adora?” Catra narrows her eyes at him.
“I tried to work it in, but she is slippery.” He replies with another rub behind his neck, “I’m doing my best to keep her from taking total control yet making sure the people aren’t going to go into an outright panic if they find out she’s a…” he whispers the last part to Catra, “witch.”
“I knew it!” Catra shouts out, “Let me question her.”
“How?”
“Distract your parents so I can get her alone.” Catra suggests, “We need to isolate her.”
“What if she bewitches you too?” Adam frowns, “I can’t lose you too.”
“Bro, have you met me?” Catra deadeyes him and then grins, “If she can’t get to you, do you really think she’ll get to me?”
Adam chuckles, patting Catra on the shoulder, “I guess not. We are very smart after all.”
“Sure…” Catra half-heartedly agrees, “Okay, come on. We need to get Adora back.”
“Wait!” He grabs Catra’s arm, “I have one question before we go.”
“What now?” Catra groans, pulling her arm free, “We don’t have time for this.”
“We do. It’s just one question.” He says before biting his bottom lip.
“Well?” Catra says irritated, “Ask your stupid question already!”
“Alright, alright!” Adam grunts out, “Do you love my sister?”
“Of course I do. What kind of stupid ass question is that?” Catra replies even more annoyed.
“No, I don’ t mean like a platonic, best friend kind of love.” Adam clarifies, “I mean like, do you love her… romantically?”
Catra goes silent, glaring at him, “I…” she starts before looking away, “It doesn’t matter. She’s going to marry that she-hulk of a woman that beat my ass and that’s that.”

“No. Answer the question.” Adam sighs, “Please.”
“Why does it…?” Catra starts and Adam punches her in the shoulder, “Ow! Okay, yes. I love her. In… that way. But it doesn’t matter!”
Adam smirks, “I knew it!”
“Great. Whatever.” Catra growls, “Let’s interrogate Shadow Weaver, get Adora back and then she can marry the sand princess.”
Adam looks over at the magicat sullenly, “I’m… I’m sorry.”
“Whatever.” Catra scoffs, “Come on, let’s do this.”
“Okay.”

Adam pushes the doors open and the pair of them step back in shock.
“What are you doing here?” Catra growls out at the sight of Huntara in the throne room with the king, queen and Shadow Weaver.
“Hush you!” The king scolds the magicat, “How dare you barge in and raise your voice in here.”
Catra bites her tongue as she glares down the other woman, Huntara just laughs out loud, “Come back to get your ass handed to you again, kitty?”
Catra growls louder as the others in the room laugh with Huntara, except Adam who clears his throat, “Uh, can I have a word with you guys in private?” he looks at Shadow Weaver, “Please.”
The king and queen eye Adam suspiciously, “What is this about, Adam?”
“It’s Adora.” He chuckles nervously, “I think I’ve got a lead. You guys need to come with me to the… uh… war room so I can show you where I think she is.”
“Adora?” Huntara says her name and Catra grits her teeth, “Ah, yes. My future wife.”
“Uh, yeah.” Adam chuckles again awkwardly, “Come on.”
He manages to separate the group, leaving Shadow Weaver and Catra in the room together, mouthing, “Find her!”
Catra nods back as Shadow Weaver tilts her head at the magicat, “Ah, you must be Catra.” Shadow Weaver says with disdain, “You

were the reason I had to wait longer."
"Wait longer?" Catra repeats, tilting her head as well and frowning down, "I've never met you, witch."
"Such slander." Shadow Weaver growls out, "No wonder you never got knighted."
Catra fists her hands, trying to stay stoic.
"What? No snarky reply?" Shadow Weaver taunts, "Pathetic. You were right. You will never be enough for her or this kingdom. You should have stayed gone."
"What did you do with her?" Catra narrows her eyes at Shadow Weaver, suppressing another growl, "Where is Adora?!"
"No need to shout." Shadow Weaver chastises, "She's… safe."
"What did you do to her?" The magicat steps forward, trying to be intimidating despite being a lot shorter than Shadow Weaver, "Tell me!"
"No." Shadow Weaver replies amused, "Huntara will become ruler of this waste of a kingdom and then we will take over the rest of the world." Shadow Weaver leans in, towering over the magicat, "And there's nothing you can do to stop me."
Catra can't help herself and slashes wildly, making contact with Shadow Weaver's masked face, the taller woman taking a few steps backwards in shock, "We're going to stop you."
Shadow Weaver rips the mask off and Catra takes a step back at the sight of her scarred face, "No. You won't."
She lifts her hand up and the next thing Catra feels is her back slamming through the door and then then crashing down to the ground in a heap, "Oof…" She looks up and Shadow Weaver is coming towards her, "Stars… gotta go!"
The magicat narrowly avoids Shadow Weaver's magic a second time and sprints out of the castle, before crashing into another person, "Oof… ow…"
"I could say the same thing." Glimmer groans as Bow helps her to her feet, "What is wrong with you!?"
"We need to go!" Catra grabs the pair, "Sparkles! Sparkle us outside of the kingdom, now!"
"What?!"
"Do it!" Catra shouts as Shadow Weaver comes out of the castle, "Now!"

“Okay!” Glimmer shouts back as the trio disappear into a cloud of sparkles.

“Ugh… I’m never getting used to that.” Catra groans as she drops to the ground once they materialise, “How do you not feel sick?”
Glimmer giggles at that as Bow helps Catra to her feet. He pats her on the back, “Are you okay?”
“Yeah, thanks.” Catra nods, “When did it get so dark?”
“Hm… that’s weird…” Bow looks up, “Sunset isn’t for another few hours… this doesn’t make any sense at all.”
“Okay. Nice save, Sparkles.” Catra shakes herself off, “Stay here and keep an eye on whatever is going on. Shadow Weaver is up to something.”
“Well, duh.” Glimmer rolls her eyes, “What exactly are we supposed to do?”
“See if you can find a way to neutralize her magic or something.” Catra looks around waiting for her eyes to adjust, “I think I know where Adora is.”
“Wait! No. We’re coming with you!” Glimmer calls out, “Bow! Do that thing!”
“Oh, right!” Bow shoots his arrow towards Catra, it’s a trick arrow and a rope lasso’s around Catra’s wrist, “Booyah! I knew it would come in handy!”
Catra gives the rope and experimental tug before sighing, “Look, don’t slow me down. Got it?”
“Sure. I got plenty of rope in case you get too far ahead.” Bow grins proudly, “Now, let’s go get our best friend!”

Catra comes of a stop at the edge of the tree line, exactly where Adora and her had stopped a week ago when the blonde tried to convince the magicat to go on an adventure. She peers inside but it’s completely dark. Then she sniffs the air and her eyes widen. The magicat tugs on the rope on her wrist, glad that it’s there this time as she cautiously makes her way inside, her eyes barely able to pick up on anything until her foot suddenly comes into contact

with something soft.
She sniffs the air again and then quickly crouches down, “Adora!”
No reaction.
“Adora?” Catra feels around in the dark, before cradling the blonde in her arms, “Adora?”
The magicat pulls the blonde’s chest of her face, her ear against Adora’s neck as she checks to see if she’s still alive. Catra’s not sure if the warmth she feels is from Adora or just her own body heat.
“Come on, princess…” Catra mutters under her breath before she gasps when she feels the rise and fall of Adora’s chest, “Thank the stars… Adora?” The magicat shakes the blonde, “Adora!”
No response.
“Stars…” Catra sighs, “Come on, princess…”
“Catra! Are you in there?!” Bow shouts.
“Where else would she be, Bow!?” Glimmer groans, “If she’s still attached to the rope, she’s definitely in there.”
“Guys! I found Adora!” Catra calls back, lifting Adora into her arms, “Taut the rope!”
“Okay!” Bow pulls back on the rope, “Like this?”
“Yeah, keep it stretched so I can find my way back out!” Catra shouts back as she feels the rope pulling her towards the way she came in.
“Is she alright?!” Glimmer yells, “Adora!”
“She’s breathing!” Catra yells back, “But… she’s not responding!”
“Hurry! Get her out now!” Glimmer starts to pull on the rope.
“Glim! Not so fast!” Bow tells her, “You’re going to make Catra fall!”
“Oh, sorry!” Glimmer lets go of the rope and lets Bow take back over again, “Hurry your furry ass up!”
“Shut it, Sparkles!” Catra shouts back as she slowly makes her way back to her friends.
“I can’t see much at all.” Bow says and Glimmer gets and idea, making a light orb with her magic, Bow smiles, “Better.”
Catra stumbles out, but still managing to gently lay Adora on the ground, “She’s breathing.”
“Thank the stars!” Glimmer sighs out in relief, “Why isn’t she waking up?”

“I don’t know.” Catra kneels next to the blonde, “That’s just how I found her.”
“It’s strange.” Bow examines her, “It’s like she’s in a comatose state, or a deep sleep…”
Glimmer turns back to Catra, “Did you find anything in there with her?”
“Like what?” Catra frowns back at Glimmer.
“I don’t know.” Glimmer scratches her head, “Bones, maybe?”
“Bones?” Catra thinks back, “I didn’t feel any bones when I searched around.”
“Okay, maybe not bones…” Glimmer thinks a little harder, “Nuts? Weapons? Fruit?”
Catra shakes her head before her ears perk up, “Wait, I’m pretty sure I smelt an apple. Or well… A rotting apple. Why?”
“Sleeping curse.” Glimmer sighs.
“Sleeping curse?” Bow repeats.
“Yeah, sleeping curse.” Glimmer confirms.
“What is a sleeping curse, exactly?” Catra asks as she brushes a few strands of hairs off Adora’s face, “How do we wake her up?”
"*We* don’t.” Glimmer smugly says, “You have to wake her up.”
“How, Sparkles?” Catra asks warily.
“True loves kiss, duh!” Glimmer grunts out, “Just, kiss her, you dumbass.”
“What?!” Catra’s fur bristles at the suggestion, “I’m not kissing Adora when she’s unconscious! This isn’t some stupid fairy tale!”
“It’s the only way to break the curse!” Glimmer shouts out, “Just get over yourself and kiss her!”
“I… I can’t.” Catra takes a step back, “That’s crossing way too many lines.”
“Ugh!” Glimmer groans, “This is the only way to wake her up. No matter how stupid it is!”
“Are you sure, Glim?” Bow asks, “I’m kind of with Catra on this one… seems… kind of stupid.”
“You both are stupid!” Glimmer throws her hands up in the air, “Do you want to wake her up, or not?!”
“She needs medical attention. Not a kiss.” Catra crosses her arms over her chest, “A healer or something.”
“No.” Glimmer groans, running her fingers down her face in

frustration, “It’s a curse! Just… trust me! I can feel the magic around her. Why do you think she can breathe on her own? Or that she hasn’t messed herself or anything. It’s magic! And it’s the sleeping curse!”
Bow nods, “Hm, you’ve got a point there, Glim.”
Glimmer turns back to Catra, “Kiss her and if she doesn’t wake up, then I’ll admit that I’m wrong.”
“Ugh, fine!” Catra gives in and takes a step forward, dropping to her knees as she gently touches Adora’s cheek, “This is stupid.”
“You’re stupid!” Glimmer retorts back, sticking her tongue out.
“You’re such a child.” Catra shakes her head.
Glimmer replies by blowing a raspberry back at the magicat, making Catra laugh as she takes a deep breath in.
“Wait… haven’t you guys kissed?” Bow asks.
Catra looks at him wide eyed, “Uh… no?”
“Oh…” Bow finally understands before turning to Glimmer, “You owe me twenty bucks.”
Catra ignores the pair, swallowing hard at the fact her first kiss with Adora or with anyone at all, is not even going to remember it let alone consent to it.
“Okay. I got this…” Catra psych’s herself up, “She’s not going to be mad at you…”
The magicat leans in and just before her lips touch Adora’s she’s harshly yanked back and thrown against a tree, the sound of laughter rings out in her ears as she shakes it off, “What…?”
“Trying to kiss my future wife, are you?” Huntara voice booms out as Glimmer’s orb of light disappears, fire lanterns taken over, “Bring them to my castle back in the Crimson Waste. Now!”
“I look forward to disposing of all of you.” Shadow Weaver’s voice comes across as the trio are apprehended and Adora’s body is picked up by Huntara and flung over the large woman’s shoulder, “Good try though. Next time, don’t take so long.”

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“You’re seriously going to make us all walk to the Crimson Waste?” Glimmer scoffs back, waving her arms around, “Do you

know who I am?!”
“Yes.” Huntara replies, “I also know that you’ve drained your powers. So, good luck trying anything.”
Glimmers glares as Huntara starts to laugh again, “Bright Moon is going to destroy you and… hey! Where is that scary woman?”
“Starting wars, are we?” Huntara smirks, “Go ahead. You’ll be fighting against two kingdoms in that case. Shadow Weaver has taken Adora back to her kingdom.”
“You better not hurt her.” Catra threatens before she’s shoved forward by Huntara’s lacky, the magicat tries to turn around to growl at them when she’s shoved forward again, nearly tripping as the binds around her wrist dig into her skin behind her back.
“Leave her alone!” Glimmer yells out, the sparkly princess reaches out to untie Catra’s hand when she’s also shoved backwards, “Hey!”
“No. Kitty’s staying tied up. I’ve seen those claws of hers.” Huntara scolds Glimmer who huffs back, “Now, shut it, Glitter.”
“Don’t bother, Sparkles.” Catra calms Glimmer down, “There’s no point talking to her.” She looks at Huntara, “Thugs like her aren’t worth your breath.”
“Thug?” Huntara grabs the magicat and hoists her up. “Say that to my face.”
Catra smirks back and leans forward, “Thug.”

THWACK!

“You’re lucky you’re my only leverage against that witch.” Huntara growls out, “Otherwise I would have already ended your life.”
“Well, lucky me.” Catra shakes off the fist to the face, her hands tied behind her back, “Make this an even playing field and untie me, your thug-ness.”
Huntara leans in, a smirk on her own lips, “No.”
“Coward.” Catra taunts and earns herself a headbutt to her head, “Ow… thug…”
“Keep that up and I’ll cut out that sharp tongue of yours too.” Huntara threatens, this time drawing her sword and holding it up to the magicat’s throat, “So? Anything else to say?”
“Catra, don’t.” Bow pleads.
The magicat looks at Bow and then to Glimmer, who shrugs, “I

don’t care, either way. But… yeah, try not to antagonise the brute with your absolute sparkling personality.”
Catra chokes out a laugh, “You’re sparkly.”
“Whatever.” Glimmer grins back.
“Shut up! All of you!” Huntara growls out, “Next one who speaks without my say, I’m going to break their fingers. Got me?”
The trio just look at her and then to each other.
The large woman growls again as she jabs Bow in the chest, “I said, did you get me?”
“Uh…” Bow chuckles nervously.
“What?”
“Please don’t break my fingers!” Bow quickly gets out, holding his arms up and then quickly throwing them behind his back to hide said fingers, a grimace on his face as he waits for a reaction.
Huntara looks around at the trio and smirks, “Move!”

“Hey! Keep moving.” Huntara shoves Glimmer forward, “We don’t stop until we get home.”
Glimmer grumbles something under her breath as Bow takes her hand, encouraging her to move on. Grunting and groaning as they continue to walk to the Crimson Waste, stomping her feet in a somewhat silent protest.
The large woman huffs out at Glimmer, “Fine. We will stop for you, your majesty.”
Despite the fact that it is clearly a mockery, Glimmer takes it as a win as she drops down to a sitting position on the ground, stretching her legs out as Bow sits down next to her with a calming smile. As for Catra, Huntara trips the magicat up, making Catra fall face first into the dirt before laughing and walking over to a few fallen trees and taking a seat on one.
Catra growls out as Bow quickly goes to her aid, pulling out a small knife he keeps with him and slashing at the magicat’s wrist binds, “Shh…”
Catra nods.
“Are you okay, Catra?” He asks trying to seem normal and the magicat nods again, “Come on, I’ll help you sit up.”
“Cat? Are you alright?” Glimmer softly asks as she watches

Huntara slide down from sitting on top of the log to the ground to lean against it, closing her eyes and then nodding off into an impromptu nap, "Thank the stars… we have to go. Hold on… and brace your stomach…"
The trio disappear into a flash of Sparkles while Huntara sleeps. Her lacky's unable to stop them.

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"Ugh… why does that suck so much?!" Catra heaves as she drops to her hands and knees trying to recover from teleporting with Glimmer's magic.
"Stop being such a baby." Glimmer chastises, "Come on, my magic didn't get us that far. So we need to move."
Bow looks around and stops, before rushing over to climb a tree not too far away to get a better look before coming back down, "Glimmer's right. We need to move. I just saw Huntara get up and she's not happy."
"Does she even know which direction to go?" Catra asks as she gets back to her feet, dusting off herself, "What direction did she look like she was going?"
"Uh…" Bow grimaces at not knowing the answer.
"Move." Catra pushes Bow out the way and quickly climbs to the top of the tree and takes a good look, muttering to herself, "Stupid sand princess…" She spots them and then quickly clambers back down again to her companions, "They're headed towards the Crimson Waste."
"Good." Glimmer breathes out in relief, "We can go help Adora."
"They're going to know we're coming." Catra tells them, "We need a plan."
"We have a plan." Bow says with a grin and Catra narrows her eyes at him in surprise, before he says, "We get to Bright Moon. Glimmer will teleport us in, I'll hold everyone off with my awesome arrows while Glimmer magic's around while you go and kiss Adora."
"That… is not a plan." Catra groans at the same time as Glimmer says, "Magic around?!"

“Look, we can figure out a plan on the way there. We’ve got at least a few hours walk back to the castle anyway.” Catra sighs and then turns to Glimmer, “No magics. Save your powers for the fight.”
“I wasn’t *planning* on using my magic.” Glimmer rolls her eyes at the magicat.
“Great.” Bow pushes in the middle, sensing the tensions rising, “Let’s get moving. We should hopefully be back by sunrise.”
“What?” Gimmer says a little too loudly, “We are not walking through the night.”
“Why not?” Catra asks.
“Because, by the time we get there, we or I should say, I, will be useless if I haven’t had any rest at all. And my magic is not going to recharge without rest.” Glimmer tells them, “We’ll need to stop to rest is all I’m saying.”
“Glimmer’s got a point…” Bow says.
“She’s always got a point.” Catra replies to Bow flatly, “Whatever.”
“You should rest too.” Bow pats the magicat on the shoulder, “When we get to the edge of the castle, we’ll take a break and recharge.”
“We need to sleep.” Glimmer clarifies, “All of us.”
“I’ll sleep when I’m dead.” Catra grumbles.
“What was that?” Glimmer asks knowingly.
“Nothing.” Catra grunts back, ears down and tail lashing, “Come on. We need to get Adora back.”

***

“What is the meaning of this?!” Adam shouts when he catches a glimpse of his sister being carried into the castle by a few of the kingdom’s knights, “Hey! Hey! I’m talking to you!” He shouts as he steps in front of them and is quickly shoved off to the sides, “You will regret that.”
“Enough!” Shadow Weaver sweeps him up and against the wall, she narrows her eyes at him and tilts her head, “I wonder why you don’t seem to be affected…”
“Stop it!” He struggles, kicking at nothing, “Let my family go!”

“No.” She drops him carelessly to the ground, signalling for the guards to keep moving Adora’s body to its new location, “I quite enjoy having royalty as my puppets. But you…”
Adam tries to get up to his feet, only to be slammed back down again, “Ow…”
“You… I think I’ll get rid of.” Adam’s eyes widen as Shadow Weaver chuckles, “I didn’t think it would this easy… I should thank Adora for this. After all, without her, I wouldn’t have been able to escape my prison.”
Adam glares up at her, “Who are you, really?”
“I. I am your messiah.” Shadow Weaver says with great conviction as she brings Adam back up into the air, this time using her dark magic to choke him, “Don’t worry, my prince. This is going be painful… Oof… what?”
“Leave my husband alone!” A red headed woman tackles Shadow Weaver to ground and lands one solid punch against her head before rushing over to Adam, “Adam! Adam! Are you okay?”
“I’m… I’m fine.” Adam coughs out, letting his wife help him up, “Thank you, Teela.” He looks around, pulling Teela’s sword out from its sheath, “Where did that witch go?!”
Teela looks around, “Sneaky bitch!”
“Come on.” He grabs Teela’s arm, “We need to save my sister!”
They both take off in the direction Adam saw Adora being taken away.

“Okay! We’re at the edge of the castle’s woods.” Bow declares happily before slumping down exhausted, “Time for some shut eye, I think.”
Glimmer yawns, dropping down next to him on the soft grass, “Set your alarm please, Bow?”
“You got it, Glim.” Bow taps his device a few times before stretching out, “Catra?”
“Yeah?”
“Come over.” Bow waves her towards them, “You need to rest too.”
“I don’t. I’m fine.” Catra scoffs out before being yanked down by Glimmer, “Hey!”

“Shut it, Catra and get your furry ass over here.” Glimmer demands, “It’s not a cuddle pile unless we have more than 2 people.”
“Gross.” Catra sticks her tongue out as she curls herself into a ball to sleep, “What the…?
“What?” Glimmer quirks an eyebrow as she pulls the magicat into her, “You’re warm and soft. So, you’re a perfect pillow.”
“Can I?” Bow asks to join in as well using his best puppy dog eyes.
“Ugh, fine.” Catra relents, “But keep your hands to yourself. Both of you.”
Glimmer and Bow both squeal in delight as they sandwich the magicat between the two of them and it’s not long before they all fall asleep.

***

Glimmer rouses awake, smacking her lips in thirst and then a yawn, “Mm… Morning.”
“Good morning!” Bow opens his eyes to the sun starting to rise, he stretches out and yawns, “Mm… Catra?”
There’s no response from the magicat as the pair both shoot up from where they lay.
“That rascal!” Glimmer gets up to her feet and just as she’s about to start swearing and cursing the magicat out, Catra drops to the ground, tilting her head down at Glimmer, “Oh. There you are.”
“Got something to say, Sparkles?” Catra smirks.
“No.” Glimmer says innocently, “Come on, lets get your girl back so you can finally kiss her.”
“I’m not kissing Adora!” Catra protests, “She needs medical help!”
“Ugh, whatever.” Glimmer rolls her eyes, “Kiss her and then tell me I’m wrong. That was the deal.”
“We’re wasting time!” Catra grumbles out as she goes to grab Bow up to his feet.
“No.” Glimmer tugs Catra into her so the magicat will listen, “I’m serious, Catra. One kiss. It’ll literally take you a second and if that doesn’t work, we’ll get the best healers and what nots to fix her.”

“Okay, fine.” Catra reluctantly agrees, “Can we go now?”
“Shouldn’t we have a plan?” Bow asks.
“We have a plan.” Catra groans, “Save Adora.”
“That’s not a plan.” Bow frowns, “It needs to have more than one step.”
“How about this?” Catra shakes her head, “I’m going up the wall and into Adora’s room. Glimmer you go in the back and Bow, you just walk in the front.”
“And then…?” Bow gestures for Catra to go on.
“That’s it.” Catra shrugs, “If we make it, we’ll all meet in the throne room.”
“Why the throne room?” Glimmer pops up.
“Because that’s where Shadow Weaver is going to be.” Catra rolls her eyes, “Don’t you know anything? She wants power and the most powerful spot is in the throne room where she will lift herself above the king and queen.”
“Oh. Right.” Bow nods along, really not knowing at all.
“Question.” Glimmer raises her hand, “How do we take down Shadow Weaver or any of the castle’s guards or soldiers if they’re all under her influence?”
“Knock them out. Simple.” Catra replies, “Now, stop asking stupid questions and let’s go save Adora.”

***

“What’s going on, Adam?” Teela whispers to Adam as he drags her into Adora’s room, “Why are we in your sister’s room?”
“Trust me. They won’t look in here.” Adam whispers back as he starts rummaging through his sister’s things, “Help me find some weapons. I know she’s got a sword in here somewhere.”
“What the fuck are you doing in here?” Catra’s voice rasps, scaring both Adam and Teela who both jump in surprise, only Adam making more of a squeaking noise when he hears her, “Get your grubby hands off Adora’s underwear.”
Adam looks down and sure enough he has one hand in Adora’s underwear drawer, he yelps, flicking the item back in the drawer and slamming it shut and then giving Catra a sheepish grin,

before pulling Catra in for a hug, “Stars! I’m so glad you’re okay!”
“Where’s Adora?” Catra asks pulling herself free from Adam’s hold before she’s enveloped in Teela’s arms and then grumbling, “Why do you guys have to be huggers?”
“We just missed you, Catra.” Teela gives the magicat one more squeeze, “And Adora was absolutely miserable without you.”
“Yeah, well, she agreed to marry the sand princess.” Catra scoffs.
“She’s an idiot.” Teela says with a shake of her head that makes Catra feel a little better and maybe even has her tilting her lips up in a smile a little, “She loves you. She’s such an idiot.”
“Sounds like Adora.” Adam chuckles, “Must be a family thing.”
“You said it.” Catra points out, “But, still, it doesn’t matter. You know how she is.”
“It does matter.” Adam pats the magicat on the shoulder, “We’ll make her see that she’s an idiot.”
“Uh huh.” Catra doesn’t believe them, “Where’s Adora?”
“Throne room.” Teela replies, “They carried her off. She looked like she was knocked out or something, but I couldn’t see any injuries on her.”
“Glimmer thinks it’s a sleeping curse.” Catra says amused but then that turns into confusion when Adam and Teela both look at each other, “No. It’s not a sleeping curse. She needs medical attention. Like, seriously guys!”
“Oh! You know what that means?!” Adam squeals just a little too loud to Teela, his wife quickly covering his mouth as she nods just as excitedly, turning to face Catra, “True loves kiss!”
“Not you too…” Catra groans.
“Yes! I mean it’s really sad Adora’s under a sleeping curse…” Adam starts before perking up, “But this will prove that she loves you and only you. And that marrying Huntara is a really bad idea!”
“Uh huh.” Catra sighs out, “Whatever. We need to get to the Throne Room then.”
“Yeah, we do.” Teela agrees, “But, we also need weapons.”
Catra unsheathes her claws, “Will this do?”
“Yeah, for you.” Adam chuckles, “What about us?”
“Don’t your muscles count for anything?” Catra points to the pair, “Why do you even need weapons?”
“Because I’m not blocking sword strikes with my fleshy, muscly

arms.” Teela replies with a shake of her head and flexes her biceps proudly, “So, yes. Weapons would be great.”
“And… why the fuck are you looking here? In Adora’s room?” Catra asks, “Why not just go get your weapons from your room?”
“Can’t. They’ll be expecting us to go back there.” Adam answers before a light bulb pops up in his head, “Hey, Catra!”
“What?”
“You know Adora better than anyone, right?” Adam asks.
“Yeah?”
“So… where does ‘Dor keep her weapons?” Adam finally gets the question out, “I know she’s got a sword somewhere…”
“Did you check under her pillow?” Catra points to the bed.
Teela trudges over and flips the pillows off and sure enough there is a sword and a dagger under her pillows, she picks up both, throwing the dagger to Adam who grins back before asking Catra, “Why is she hiding weapons under her pillows?”
“No idea. She’s not my sister.” Catra replies before gesturing to the door, “Doesn’t Adam do the same?”
Teela sighs, “Yes. Yes, he does.”
“Well, must be a family thing.” Catra surmises, “Can we go now?”
“Yes.” Teela confirms, grabbing Adam and leading him to the door, “Let me go and check it out first.”
“Okay, be careful.” Adam says and presses a kiss onto her forehead, “I love you.”
“I love you too.” Teela replies.
“Ugh, gross.” Catra groans as the pair ignore here.
Teela slowly opens the door and then peers out, taking a breath in and then quickly ducking out and into the hallways.
Adam turns to Catra and whisper shouts, “Don’t worry, we’ll get Adora back.”
Catra just nods.
In less than a minute, Teela returns and grabs the pair out, “Come on!” she whispers harshly, “Coast is clear!”

***

“Halt! What are you doing here?” A guard shouts out to Bow casually walking through the front doors, “State your business!”
“Oh, hi guys!” Bow waves friendly to the room, “I’m just going to go see my best friend!”
He is stopped by two guards, spears pointed towards his throat as he throws his hands up in surrender and chuckles nervously, the head guard steps forward and narrows his eyes at Bow, “And who is this ‘best friend’ of yours?”
“Princess Adora of course!” He grins wider, “One third of the Best Friends Squad!”
The head guard looks him up and down, before turning around, “No. No one enters today.”
“Oh.” Bow says a little dejected, “Then I’ll come back tomorrow.”
“No.” The head guard repeats, “No one enters tomorrow either.”
“Then I’ll come back the next day. And the next day. And the next day...” Bow’s about to continue when the head guard spins on his heels and shoves Bow down to the ground, “Ow… that was not necessary.” He groans trying to get back to his feet only to be pushed back down again. He looks up in confusion, “Why can’t I see my best friend?”
“No one enters.” The head guard repeats himself a little more forcefully this time.
“By who’s order?” Bow scoffs out, “I’m a welcomed guest!”
“Not anymore.” The guard smirks, “Shadow Weaver has deemed you unworthy. Now, leave.”
“Hey! Leave Bow alone!” The head guard cries out when a bolt of sparkly magic hits him in the face, Glimmer teleporting in and helping Bow up to his feet, “Are you okay?”
“Yeah. I’m good. Thanks Glim.” Bow replies with a grateful smile before pulling out his Bow and loading up some arrows, “Time to get creative!”

***

Adam and Teela burst through the throne room doors, bits of wood splintering outwards as Catra sprints in through the middle as they start to fight the king and queen’s personal guards.

“Kill them!” Shadow Weaver commands as the king and queen look on, their eyes glazed over and a stupefied look on their faces as the witch adds, “You too. Get in there, your majesties.”
“Mother! Father! What are you doing?!” Adam shouts out as he knocks out a guard before going back to back with his wife, “Snap out of it!”
“They can’t! “Catra shouts to him as she spots Adora, “I see her! I see Adora!”
“Go get her! We’ll cover you!” Teela shouts even though they are completely busy with their own fight, “Go!”
Shadow Weaver takes a step back, the queen and king move around her, pulling out their swords and brandishing them at the magicat, “Attack! Kill the creature!”
The king and queen both nod as they start to advance on Catra, the queen striking first as the magicat evades the strike, “Woah!”
The queen’s eyes clear for a moment as she tries to fight the magic, “I’m sorry, Catra…” before her eyes glaze over again and she begins to attack the magicat again, the exertion doesn’t seem to affect her as Catra continues to dodge and evade the strikes.
“I’m sorry my queen.” Catra quickly says as she elbows the queen in the face, knocking her out before breaking her fall and guiding her down gently before howling out when she feels something stab into her side, rolling off to the side and looking up, her hand goes to where the stab resides and blood covers it, “Stars… that’s not good.”
The king runs full speed at the magicat, his sword at the ready to run Catra through, grunting hard as Catra dodges him at the last minute, pushing him forward and straight into the wall. He grunts again as he rights himself and goes for a second try.
Shadow Weaver glares at Catra, moving behind her with speed and holds her in place with her hands on her shoulders, “Kill her!”
“My king! Please! Don’t!” Catra pleads as she watches the king get closer and closer to her, sword in position to run her through as she shuts her eyes and grits her teeth, ready for the inevitable.
“Catra!” A welcomed voice shouts as the king’s growls out as a burst of sparkles hits him in the face, “We’re coming!”
“No!” Shadow Weaver shouts as she’s hit with one of Bow’s trick arrows, the arrow snagging her garbs and throwing her

backwards, pinning her to the wall, “Kill them!” She shouts out again to the remaining guards.
“Good to see you, Sparkles.” Catra breathes out in relief as the sparkly girl pulls the magicat into a brief hug, “Go get Adora!”
Catra’s eyes widen, as she shoves Glimmer out of the way as the king attacks again, he manages to get her other side this time, just as she’s close enough to knock him out in a similar fashion to the queen, except with the added sword impaled into her side, Glimmer helps guide the king safely to the ground.
“Catra!” Glimmer quickly rushes back to the magicat as Catra drops to her knees, “No! Get up!”
“I’m… I’m done for.” Catra breathes out as Adam and Teela finish off the rest of the guards and go to help Bow deal with Shadow Weaver, “Go… save Adora.”
“We can’t! Only you can, you dumbass!” Glimmer shout out before looking around, “Help! Catra’s hurt!”
Shadow Weaver laughs out despite being held in place by Bow, Adam and Teela, “Looks like I win after all.”
“No. You don’t.” Adam seethes as he brings the dagger up to Shadow Weaver’s throat.
“Adam, no!” Teela quickly grabs his arms back, “I got this.”
“You? And who are you?” Shadow Weaver taunts.
“Oh, we haven’t been formally introduced. I’m Teela.” Teela says before punching Shadow Weaver in the face hard enough to knock her out, the trio let her drop onto the floor in a heap, “And it’s not a pleasure to meet you, you witch!”
“Guys! Help me!” Glimmer yells out in panic, “Catra’s been stabbed! Twice!”
The trio quickly rush over, Adam frowning down at the magicat, “Oh, no you don’t! You are not dying!” he heaves her up and into his arms, carrying her over to where Adora lays in the middle of a table, gently resting Catra next to her, “You’re not going to die, Catra! You can’t!”
Catra touches the sword still impaled inside of her and groans, turning her head to see a sleeping Adora as she tries to breathe in and out.
“Don’t pull the sword out!” Bow shouts, “She’ll bleed out if you do!”

“What do we do?!” Adam shouts in a panic as Glimmer flits around in the same state.
Teela, being the only one that’s not in a panic takes control of the situation, “Bow, go get something to stop the bleeding.”
“Bandages! I’m on it!” He shouts before running out.
“Glimmer, go get help. Find the doctors and healers. Go. Now!” Teela instructs and Glimmer nods, disappearing in a flurry of sparkles.
“Adam!” Teela shakes her husband, “Take off your shirt!”
“Tee… I don’t think this is the time for that…” Adam furrows his brows.
“No, you idiot!” Teela slaps him across the chest, “I need your shirt to help stop the bleeding, you idiot!”
“Oh… right.” He chuckles awkwardly, shucking his shirt off and giving it to Teela who wraps it around the sword and then grabs Adam’s hands, “Pressure. Now.”
Catra groans in pain with the added pressure as she keeps her eyes on Adora, a tear rolls down her cheek as she stares at the sleeping blonde, “I’m… I’m sorry, Adora…”
“None of that, Cat!” Teela scolds, “You’re not dying. I won’t allow it!”
Catra rolls her eyes as she feels herself feel colder, her teeth starting to chatter as she reaches her hand out to reach for Adora, “I… I love you, princess…”
“Shut up!” Teela says through a few tears, pushing Adora closer to Catra’s outstretched hands and rests the blonde over Catra’s outstretched arm, so she’s face to face with the magicat, “Here’s your chance, idiot!”
“I… I can’t.” Catra sighs as she continues to shiver, “It’s… it’s not right…”
Adora’s head rolls to the side, a few strands of hair fall over her cheeks hiding her face as Catra waves Adam off.
“Cat! I need to keep pressure on this!” He whines, trying to push her back onto her back.
She swipes her arm at the prince, “Give… give me a minute, would you?”
Teela grabs Adam and pulls him back, “You’ve got 30 seconds. No more.”

“Okay…” Catra agrees as the pair gives her a little privacy as she winces, rolling to her side and pushing back the hair off Adora’s face with her bloodied fingers, grimacing a bit when the blood marks Adora’s face a little, “Hey, Adora.”
Adora doesn’t respond. Her breathing remaining the same as she looks serene in a deep sleep.
“You know I love you, right?” Catra whispers, “I’m… I’m sorry I couldn’t save you…”
Catra wraps her free arm around Adora’s body, bringing her closer as she presses a soft kiss onto Adora’s forehead before groaning and falling onto her back in pain, hissing out before shutting her eyes and shivering once more.

***

Adora’s eyes open and she takes a deep breath in, she’s suddenly aware she’s no longer in the woods and now back in the castle. Her castle and in the very distinct Throne Room, given the artwork on the ceiling looks blurry. She’s also acutely aware she’s laying on the table that most of the meetings take place, except, there’s something she seems to be on top of.
She looks around, her eyes adjusting slowly to everything as her hands reach out and feel a familiar figure next to her. She furrows her brows, unhappy that her vision is still blurry as her hands reach up and feels a furry cheek and the familiar ears that she’s come to love so much and then it hits her.
Catra.
“Catra?” She cups the magicat’s face, but there’s no response, her best friend’s face cool to the touch as she leans in and whispers a little softer, “Catra?”
Still nothing.
Her hand reaches down, her fingers feel sticky and then it touches something hard and sharp.
Her eyes finally clear up and the sight in front of her has her gasping.
“Catra!” She screams out, her hands hover over the magicat, not knowing what to do as Adam and Teela rush back in, Glimmer and

Bow appear a few seconds later and a few healers and doctors hot on their heels, "What's going on?!"
Teela ignores Adora as Adam pulls her off the table so the healers can get to Catra, Bow shoves the bandages into Teela's arms as Glimmer goes to check on the king and queen.
"What is happening?!" Adora screams out, "Catra!"
"It's okay, Adora." Adam reassures his sister, pulling her into a hug from the back, "We were so worried about you."
"I'm fine!" Adora tries to get free of his arms and failing, "Let me go! I need to help Catra!"
"She's getting help now." He tries to say reassuringly, "You have to let them work."
"I…" Adora turns in Adam's arms, throwing her arms around his neck, "What happened?"
"We'll explain later." Adam promises and then notices Shadow Weaver in the corner, still slumped over unconscious, "In the meantime, we need to go take care of our new friend over there."
Adora looks over and frowns, "She is *not* a friend."
Adam chuckles, "Figure of speech, idiot."

***

"Adora. Daughter!" King Randor steps out and hugs Adora, the queen joining the hug from the other side, "We were so worried!"
"Were you?" Adora quirks an eyebrow at her parents.
"Yes. At the start and the times we regained consciousness…" The king replies, "Are you okay?"
"I am." Adora steps back from the hug, "Huntara… I'm not marrying her."
"Good. No. Definitely not." Her mother agrees readily, "Not after what she pulled with Shadow Weaver."
"We are pulling all resources from that kingdom." Her father says, "And if she dares step foot outside her own land, she'll face the wrath of all the kingdoms this planet holds."
"Good." Adora nods, "What did you do with Shadow Weaver?"
"Bright Moon is dealing with her." King Randor smiles, "I believe King Micah has a past with that… witch."

“Don’t worry, Adora.” Queen Marlena smiles back, “Where she’s going, she will not be getting out again. No amount of trickery will work.”
“But how do you know that?” Adora asks with another frown, “She got out before.”
“When you woke up, it stripped her of all her magic.” Teela answers as she walks in with Adam in tow, “You can thank Catra for that.”
“Catra! Is she okay? I need to go see her!” Adora starts to rush off, when she’s stopped abruptly by Adam grabbing her arm and swinging her back in, “Hey!”
“Hold on, sister.” He rolls his eyes at her, “You can’t go barging into her room when she’s still being fixed up. Don’t worry, she’s going to be fine.”
“How?” Adora narrows her eyes at Adam, not believing him before turning to her parents, “You ran her through with your sword!”
“I didn’t mean to.” King Randow sheepishly replies, “I was under a spell…”
“You can’t blame them, Adora.” Teela sighs, patting Adora on the shoulder, “They weren’t in control of their actions.”
Adora sighs, “What happened to me?”
“You were under a sleeping curse after possibly eating an apple.” Glimmer replies as she walks through the door, Bow following behind her, “What is wrong with you?! Why would you do that?!”
Adora turns to her friends, an embarrassed grin on her face, “I was… a little… depressed.”
“I told you!” The queen whacks her husband in the arm, “I told you! Didn’t I?”
“Yes, dear.” King Randor rubs his shoulder as he replies.
“Told him what?” Adora asks.
“That you weren’t happy.” Queen Marlena replies, crossing her arms over her chest before glaring angrily at the king, “And because you kept insisting that it’ll work out, I’ve got a bruise on my face!”
“I’ve got one too!” He argues weakly, showing the bruise on his head and getting no sympathy, “Besides, we worked out fine, didn’t we?”
“We weren’t forced into marriage.” The queen frowns at him

before turning to Adora, “Why didn’t you say anything?”
“How could I?” Adora huffs out, “You guys were making it seem like I had to unite the two kingdoms like it was for the good of the people!”
“Oh, dear…” Her mother envelopes Adora into a hug, “I’m so sorry, Adora. If only you would talk to us.”
“You never had the time for me.” Adora sighs.
“I’m sorry too.” Her father says softly, embarrassed at his actions, “I was pig-headed and only wanted what was best for you.”
“What have you got against Catra?” Adora asks as she steps back, standing with her friends now, “Why did you keep her from getting knighted?”
“We thought you and Princess Huntara were getting along.” King Randor argues petulantly, “Besides, Catra… she’s…”
“She’s what?” Adora asks, crossing her arms over her chest, “She saved me. She saved you. She saved the entire kingdom. What more does she need to do? She nearly died!”
“We love Catra.” The queen sighs, “But it doesn’t work that way.”
“Are you not the king and queen?” Adora asks, “You can change the ways.”
Her parents look at each other, her father clears his throat, “You’re right, princess.”
“I am.”
“Then. Let’s change the ways.” He says with a grin.

***

Catra wakes up in a white room, sunlight shines brightly inside as she tries to touch her wounds only to find that she can’t lift her arms, her whole body feels numb but at least she’s not in any pain.
She turns her head and sees a sight for her sore eyes.
Adora.
Adora sleeping in the chair next to her.
The blonde’s fingers intertwined with her own as she wonders if this is real or if she’s dead. Whatever machine she is hooked up to starts beeping a little louder, making her ears twitch.

“Finally!” Glimmer and Bow appear in sparkles on the other side of her bed, “We thought maybe you transferred the curse to yourself after kissing Adora!” Glimmer huffs out at Catra, “You’ve really scared us, dumbass!”
Catra looks at her, her brows up to her hairline, “Where… What happened?”
“You did it!” Bow squeals in delight, “You broke the curse!”
“I did?” Catra asks as she looks over at Adora, “But... she’s still asleep.”
“Adora!” Glimmer shakes Adora awake, “Wake up!”
“Huh, what?” Adora grumbles unhappily, “Glim! What are you doing?!”
Glimmer gestures to Catra with her eyes and Adora just furrows hers at her friend before realising.
“Catra! Oh, my stars! You’re awake!” Adora rushes over and hugs the magicat, “I thought you died!”
“Did I?” Catra asks, “Am I not dead?”
“No, you ass! You’re not dead!” Glimmer groans out.
“Oh, cool.” Catra replies feeling a little dopey from whatever is helping the pain, “What’s going on?”
“You kissed Adora and broke the curse!” Bow happily regales, “How was it?”
Adora blushes as Catra frowns, “I didn’t kiss her.”
“Yes, you did.” Glimmer argues, “Or else how did you break the curse. It was true loves kiss!”
“Guys, I didn’t kiss Adora.” Catra reiterates, “Like the last thing I remember is pulling her into me and kissing her forehead. I didn’t kiss her… you know… on the… on the lips.”
Adora breathes out a sigh of relief but then frowns, “You kissed me on the forehead?”
“Uh… yeah?”
“Eh.” Glimmer shrugs to Bow, “A kiss is a kiss I guess.”
Bow just grins wider, throwing two thumbs up at Catra, “Good work, buddy!”
“Guys, can I… can I have a moment with Catra?” Adora asks.
“Sure! We’re going to go meet Adam and Teela for lunch. Meet you there after?” Bow asks.
“Don’t bother, Bow.” Glimmer rolls her eyes, “She’s going to be in

here with Catra."
"Thanks, guys." Adora ignores that last comment.
The pair disappear in a flash of sparkles as Catra winces.
"Hey." Adora steps up next to the bed again, taking Catra's hand in hers, "Are you okay?"
"I… I think so?" Catra replies, "It's kind of hard to tell. I'm numb all over with whatever drugs they're pumping me up with."
"What can you feel?" Adora asks and Catra just looks at her not understanding as the blonde elaborates, "Where do you have feeling?"
"My face and ears, I think." Catra replies moving one ear and then the other, "Yep, that's right."
Adora smiles, "I have something to tell you, actually."
Catra tilts her head as she watches Adora bite her lip, "Yeah?"
"Your getting knighted." Adora tells her with a small smile.
"Oh. Cool, I guess." Catra nods a little before looking away, "What… what's happening with Huntara? Are you still… marrying her?"
"Stars, no." Adora breathes out, "Mother and father put an end to that."
"Good. She wasn't good for you." Catra says relieved before a bout of jealousy pangs through her, "I guess you'll be looking for new suitors then…"
"Not exactly." Adora bites her lip again as she avoids eye contact with Catra.
"I don't understand." Catra replies with a frown.
"Well… maybe…" Adora plays with Catra's numb fingers.
"Maybe what, princess?" Catra asks and when it looks like Adora is about to say something, the king and queen both appear.
"Catra! I am so sorry for stabbing you. Twice!" The king apologises, "Please forgive me."
"Uh, yeah. Of course, my king." Catra replies, "I'm… I'm uh, glad you're back to yourselves."
"Us too." The queen replies with a nod and then stands where Glimmer and Bow were earlier, "How are you feeling?"
"Numb."
The king, not reading the room then claps his hands together, "So, can we keep the original date for the wedding?"

Catra's head turns so fast to the king she nearly gets whiplash, "What?" and then back to Adora, "What wedding? Who are you marrying now? Is it Glimmer? Because I swear…"
"Hush you." Adora scolds the magicat with a small smile, "It's not Glimmer."
The blonde then glares at her father who steps back in realisation, "Oh… she hasn't asked you yet?"
"Asked who, what?" Catra asks, looking between the trio, "What is going on?"
"Guys, can you please…?" Adora huffs out.
"Oh, yes, sorry, sorry." The king backs away with a mischievous grin on his face, pulling the queen with him, before shouting back, "You have our blessings!"
"What was that about?" Catra tries to crane her neck to the door where the king and queen have both left and then back to Adora.
Adora looks back at Catra, biting her bottom lip once more, "Well… since you're getting knighted and you kind of…. Saved my life with…"
"True loves kiss?" Catra finishes and Adora's nods.
"They, uh, they are kind of…" Adora goes bright red, "Well, the kiss and everything and…"
"Adora?" Catra breaks the blonde out of her little spiral, "Are you saying that you want me to ask you to marry me?"
Adora doesn't look up, but nods. She can't handle the rejection if it's there.
Catra chuckles under her breath, "I love you, princess."
"I love you too." Adora replies, squeezing Catra's hand despite the limb being numb.
"Do you think we're going to be interrupted again in the next few minutes?" Catra asks trying to look around.
"I hope not." Adora replies with a slump of her shoulders, "They're just worried about you."
"Okay." Catra nods, "Adora?"
"Yeah?"
"Can I ask you something?"
"Yeah?"
"Can I marry you? Like… for real?" Catra asks.
"You can." Adora replies, "Why?"

“Well…” Catra’s ears flick around nervously on her head, “Uh, I love you.”
“I know.” Adora huffs out a laugh, “I love you too.”
“Okay, good.” Catra clears her throat again, “Marry me?”
Adora smiles wide, a few tears in her eyes as she leans in, “Can I kiss you now?”
“Can I stop you?” Catra grins.
“Will you be able to feel this?” Adora moves back suddenly making the magicat growl, “You said your face isn’t numb, right?”
“Adora!” Catra grumbles, “If I could move, I would be kissing you right now!”
Adora giggles, “Alright, alright.”
Catra pouts at the wait.
Adora leans in, “You know… I haven’t kissed anyone before…”
“Adora!” Catra groans before Adora’s lips are on hers in a chaste kiss that the blonde pulls back from a little too quickly.
“Wow…” Adora grins dopily.
“Does that mean yes to marrying me?” Catra asks still not a hundred percent sure.
“Does this answer your question?” Adora leans in again and presses her lips onto the magicat’s once more, a smile on her face as Catra tries to deepen the kiss before breaking off again and having Catra growl again, she presses a kiss onto Catra’s forehead, “Yes.”
“Yeah?”
“Yes, you idiot!” Adora laughs and comes back in for more kisses.
“Get over here, princess.” Catra tells her, “On the bed, you’re too far away!”
Adora laughs again, “So… true loves kiss, huh?”
“I’ve always loved you, princess.” Catra sighs, “It only took me having to storm the castle and nearly get myself killed to be worthy of you.”
“You’ve always been worthy of me, Catra.” Adora presses another kiss onto Catra’s lips, “Mm… I love you.”
Catra grins, “Oh, by the way, I’m going to ask you again.”
“Oh yeah?”
“Yeah.” Catra confirms, “I’m going to ask you again when I’m not hyped up on happy numbing drugs and can actually feel most of

my face.”
“I can’t wait.” Adora replies as she settles next to Catra on the bed.
“Adora?” Catra asks as she rubs her cheek against the top of Adora’s head.
“Hm?”
“This is one fucked up fairy tale.”

End Notes

Thanks for reading!
Kudos and comments are appreciated if you would like to leave some... 😉

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